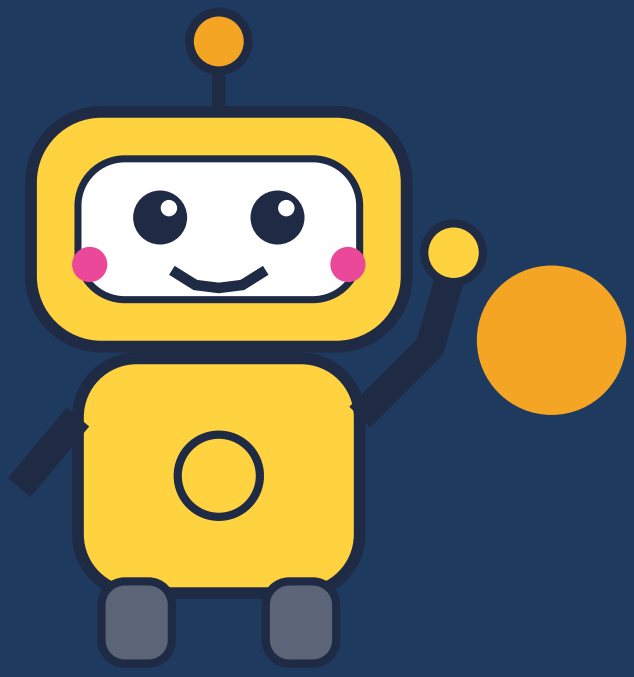
SAMPLE PAPERS

Think Like a Coder

Sample examination papers, Class 3

Half-yearly and annual papers
40 marks, 1½ hours, with blueprints and marking schemes



For CBSE's Computational Thinking and AI curriculum, 2026-27

Goes with Think Like a Coder, Class 3 · Photocopiable for school use

SAMPLE EDITION · DRAFT

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About these papers

These are two sample examination papers for Class 3: a **half-yearly** paper on the term-1 chapters and an **annual** paper on the whole year. They go with *Think Like a Coder*, Class 3, and with the chapter assessments. All questions are new.

How they follow CBSE

- CBSE does not hold board examinations for Classes 3-8 and has not published a question-paper pattern for CT&AI.; Schools set their own papers. These papers follow what CBSE's CT&AI; handbooks describe: **competency-based** written tests with CT puzzles, with no 'write a program' questions and no computer needed.
- The question types are the ones CBSE uses in its competency-based papers: multiple choice, short answers and case-based questions.
- Questions are spread across four thinking levels (remember, understand, apply, analyse and create), with most marks for applying and analysing. The blueprints show the split.
- Chapters follow the order of CBSE's 2026-27 CT&AI; handbooks and the NCERT maths chapters.

Paper design

Section	Question type	Questions	Marks
A	Multiple choice	8	8 x 1 = 8
B	Very short answer	6	6 x 2 = 12
C	Short answer	4	4 x 3 = 12
D	Case-based questions	2	2 x 4 = 8
	Total · 1½ hours	20	40

Using the papers

- Use the half-yearly paper in September and the annual paper in February-March, or as mock tests before the school's own exams.
- Print one paper per student; the papers have space for answers.
- Read questions aloud to students who find reading hard: the paper tests thinking, not reading.
- Mark with the marking scheme; accept any correct method, and give part marks for correct steps.
- Use the blueprints to set your own papers in the same pattern.

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SAMPLE PAPER · HALF-YEARLY EXAMINATION

Class 3 · Computational Thinking

Syllabus: chapters 1-7 (term 1)

Time allowed: 1½ hours **Maximum marks:** 40

Name: _____ **Section:** _____ **Roll no.:** _____

General instructions

1. This paper has 20 questions in 4 sections. All questions are compulsory.
   Section A: multiple choice, 8 questions of 1 mark each; Section B: very short answer, 6 questions of 2 marks each;
2. Section C: short answer, 4 questions of 3 marks each; Section D: case-based questions, 2 questions of 4 marks each.
3. Marks for each question are shown on the right.
4. Write your answers in the space given below each question.
5. No calculator or computer is needed. Show your working: marks are given for correct steps.

SECTION A · Multiple choice — 8 x 1 = 8 marks

1. Writing each letter as a different letter, using a rule, makes a ... [1]

a) secret code **b)** number line **c)** pattern block

2. With key +1, the code for SUN is ... [1]

a) TVO **b)** RTM **c)** TUN

3. Looking at a cup from the top, you see a ... [1]

a) circle **b)** triangle **c)** square

4. Start at 60. Add 20 three times. Where do you end? [1]

a) 80 **b)** 100 **c)** 120

5. Which step comes first when you plant a seed? [1]

a) water the soil **b)** dig a small hole

c) watch it grow

6. What comes next? triangle, circle, circle, triangle, circle, circle, ... [1]

a) circle **b)** triangle **c)** square

7. In 'when the whistle blows, start running', the event is ... [1]

a) the whistle blows **b)** start running

c) the race ends

8. 5 packets have 4 bangles each. How many bangles in all? [1]

a) 9 **b)** 20 **c)** 45

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SECTION B · Very short answer — 6 x 2 = 12 marks

9. Code the word BAT with key +2. [2]

10. You draw a map to the park for a friend. Write one thing that matters and one thing that does not. [2]

11. Write the next two numbers: 150, 175, 200, ___, ___ [2]

12. Find the bug: 1. Put on your shoes. 2. Put on your socks. 3. Tie the laces. Write the correct order. [2]

13. Write one 'when ... do ...' rule for the school bell. [2]

14. 21 laddoos are put in packets of 3. How many packets are there? [2]

SECTION C · Short answer — 4 x 3 = 12 marks

15. Write a loop that starts at 0 and reaches 100 by adding 20 each time. How many times does it repeat? Write the numbers it reaches. [3]

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16. The core of a bead pattern is red, blue, blue.

(a) Write the first 9 beads. [1]

(b) What colour is the 10th bead? [1]

(c) How many blue beads are in the first 9? [1]

17. Break 'making a sandwich' into at least 5 small steps, in order. [3]

18. Riya coded a word with key +1 and got IBU. Decode it, and say how you decoded it. [3]

SECTION D · Case-based questions — 2 x 4 = 8 marks

19. Meena's stall sold rakhis on four days: Monday 12, Tuesday 18, Wednesday 9, Thursday 15.

(a) Which day sold the most rakhis? [1]

(b) Sort the days from fewest rakhis to most. [1]

(c) How many rakhis were sold in all? [1]

(d) Tuesday's rakhis were packed in packets of 3. How many packets? [1]

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20. A counter machine has three buttons: +1, +10 and +100. It now shows 245.

(a) Press +100 once. What does it show? [1]

(b) Start again at 245. Which presses reach 300 with the fewest presses? How many presses? [2]

(c) The machine says 'Full!' at 999. Write this as a 'when ... do ...' rule. [1]

***** End of the question paper *****

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SAMPLE PAPER · ANNUAL EXAMINATION

Class 3 · Computational Thinking

Syllabus: all chapters, mostly chapters 8-14 (term 2)

Time allowed: 1½ hours **Maximum marks:** 40

Name: _____ **Section:** _____ **Roll no.:** _____

General instructions

1. This paper has 20 questions in 4 sections. All questions are compulsory.
   Section A: multiple choice, 8 questions of 1 mark each; Section B: very short answer, 6 questions of 2 marks each;
2. Section C: short answer, 4 questions of 3 marks each; Section D: case-based questions, 2 questions of 4 marks each.
3. Marks for each question are shown on the right.
4. Write your answers in the space given below each question.
5. No calculator or computer is needed. Show your working: marks are given for correct steps.

SECTION A · Multiple choice — 8 x 1 = 8 marks

1. Rule: if the ball is red, put it in box A, else put it in box B. Where does a green ball go? [1]

a) box A **b)** box B

2. I have 4 hundreds, 0 tens and 6 ones. I am ... [1]

a) 46 **b)** 406 **c)** 460

3. Sort 9, 3 and 6 from smallest to biggest. [1]

a) 3, 6, 9 **b)** 9, 6, 3 **c)** 3, 9, 6

4. On a balance, the left pan goes up. So the left side is ... [1]

a) heavier **b)** lighter **c)** the same

5. Set coins to 10. Add 5. Take away 3. Now coins is ... [1]

a) 12 **b)** 18 **c)** 8

6. How many days are there in a week? [1]

a) 5 **b)** 7 **c)** 12

7. Robo is on B2 and moves up once. Where is it now? [1]

a) B3 **b)** C2 **c)** B1

8. Keeping only the details that matter is called ... [1]

a) abstraction **b)** addition **c)** a pattern

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SECTION B · Very short answer — 6 x 2 = 12 marks

9. Share 14 pencils fairly among 3 children. How many does each child get, and how many are left? [2]

10. I am a 3-digit number between 500 and 600. My tens digit is 0 and my ones digit is 7. Who am I? [2]

11. Sort 6, 2, 5 by swapping neighbours. Write the list after each swap. [2]

12. Set water to 20 litres. Use 6 litres. Add 10 litres. Write water after each step. [2]

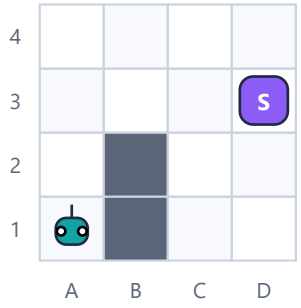
13. Today is Thursday. What day will it be after 4 days? [2]

14. Fill the gap: start at 0, repeat 4 times: add ___, to reach 200. [2]

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SECTION C · Short answer — 4 x 3 = 12 marks

15. Write the shortest list of arrows that takes Robo from A1 to the star S on D3 without going through the walls. How many arrows? [3]



16. Write an if-then-else rule for a water tank's pump. What does your rule do when the tank is half full? [3]

17. Write 3 clues so that only the number 352 fits all of them. [3]

18. A loop says: each day from Monday to Saturday, read 2 pages. How many pages is that? If you also read 4 pages on Sunday, how many pages in the week? [3]

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SECTION D · Case-based questions — 2 x 4 = 8 marks

19. Asha plays a shop game. The variable money starts at ₹50.

(a) She buys a pen for ₹12. What is money now? [1]

(b) Her aunt gives her ₹20. What is money now? [1]

(c) She buys 2 notebooks for ₹15 each. What is money now? [1]

(d) What does the variable money store? [1]

20. For the class party, children voted for snacks: samosa 8, idli 5, pakora 8, fruit 6.

(a) Sort the snacks from most votes to fewest. [1]

(b) Which two snacks are tied? [1]

(c) Write a fair rule to choose between them. [2]

***** End of the question paper *****

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Blueprints

Blueprint: Half-yearly examination

Syllabus: chapters 1-7 (term 1). Marks by chapter and section.

Chapter	A	B	C	D	Marks
1. What's in a Name?	2	2	3		7
2. Toy Joy	1	2			3
3. Double Century	1	2	3		6
4. Vacation with My Nani Maa	1	2	3		6
5. Fun with Shapes	1		3		4
6. House of Hundreds - I	1	2		4	7
7. Raksha Bandhan	1	2		4	7
Total	8	12	12	8	40

Marks by thinking level

Each question is counted at its main thinking level.

Level	What the student does	Marks	Share
Remember	recall a fact or term	2	5%
Understand	explain or interpret an idea	6	15%
Apply	use an idea or rule in a new problem	20	50%
Analyse and create	trace, debug, compare, design or justify	12	30%

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Blueprint: Annual examination

Syllabus: all chapters, mostly chapters 8-14 (term 2). Marks by chapter and section.

Chapter	A	B	C	D	Marks
2. Toy Joy	1				1
3. Double Century		2			2
8. Fair Share	1	2			3
9. House of Hundreds - II	1	2	3		6
10. Fun at Class Party!	1	2		4	7
11. Filling and Lifting	1		3		4
12. Give and Take	1	2		4	7
13. Time Goes On	1	2	3		6
14. The Surajkund Fair	1		3		4
Total	8	12	12	8	40

Marks by thinking level

Each question is counted at its main thinking level.

Level	What the student does	Marks	Share
Remember	recall a fact or term	2	5%
Understand	explain or interpret an idea	2	5%
Apply	use an idea or rule in a new problem	24	60%
Analyse and create	trace, debug, compare, design or justify	12	30%

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Marking schemes

Accept any correct method and any sensible wording. Give part marks for correct steps, even when the final answer has a slip.

Marking scheme: Half-yearly examination

1. a) secret code
2. a) TVO
3. a) circle
4. c) 120
5. b) dig a small hole
6. b) triangle
7. a) the whistle blows
8. b) 20
9. DCV (2 marks; 1 mark if two letters are right)
10. For example, matters: the roads and where to turn; does not matter: the colour of the houses (1 mark for each)
11. 225, 250 (1 mark for each)
12. 2, 1, 3 (2 marks; 1 mark for spotting that socks come before shoes)
13. For example: when the bell rings, line up (1 mark for the event, 1 mark for the action)
14. 7 (2 marks; 1 mark for a drawing or a correct method)
15. Repeat 5 times: add 20. It reaches 20, 40, 60, 80, 100. (1 mark for the loop, 1 mark for 5 times, 1 mark for the numbers)
16. (a) red, blue, blue, red, blue, blue, red, blue, blue (b) red (c) 6 (1 mark for each part)
17. For example: take two slices of bread; spread butter; add the vegetables; put the second slice on top; cut it in half. (1 mark for 5 steps, 1 mark for a sensible order, 1 mark if each step is one small action)
18. HAT. Move each letter back by 1. (2 marks for HAT (1 mark for two letters), 1 mark for the method)
19. (a) Tuesday (b) Wednesday, Monday, Thursday, Tuesday (c) 54 (d) 6 (1 mark for each part)
20. (a) 345 (b) 10 presses: +10 five times and +1 five times (c) When the counter shows 999, say 'Full!' ((a) 1 mark; (b) 2 marks, 1 mark for 55 more; (c) 1 mark)

Marking scheme: Annual examination

1. b) box B
2. b) 406
3. a) 3, 6, 9
4. b) lighter
5. a) 12
6. b) 7
7. a) B3
8. a) abstraction
9. 4 each, 2 left (1 mark for each)
10. 507 (2 marks; 1 mark for the hundreds digit 5)
11. 2, 6, 5; then 2, 5, 6 (1 mark for each swap)
12. 14, then 24 (1 mark for each)
13. Monday (2 marks; 1 mark for counting on with one slip)
14. 50 (2 marks)
15. up, up, right, right, right: 5 arrows. Any 5-arrow route that avoids the walls is correct. (2 marks for a correct route, 1 mark for 5)
16. If the tank is full then switch the pump off, else keep the pump on. Half full: the pump stays on. (1 mark for the condition, 1 mark for both actions, 1 mark for the half-full case)
17. For example: I am between 300 and 400. My tens digit is 5. My ones digit is 2. (1 mark for each clue that helps narrow it to 352)
18. 12 pages; 16 pages (1 mark for 6 days, 1 mark for 12, 1 mark for 16)
19. (a) ₹38 (b) ₹58 (c) ₹28 (d) money stores how many rupees Asha has (1 mark for each part)
20. (a) samosa and pakora (8), fruit (6), idli (5) (b) samosa and pakora (c) For example: vote again between only those two, or toss a coin ((a) 1 mark (b) 1 mark (c) 2 marks for a fair rule, 1 mark for a rule that is not clearly fair)

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